

STRAWBERRY DREAM SET

JUMPER AND SKIRT · PREEMIE TO 2 MONTHS

A matching two-piece set: a top-down jumper with a round yoke and long sleeves, and a separate skirt with a soft elasticated waist. Both pieces share the same leaf and seed pattern. Graded in five sizes.

32

preemie, approx. 1.0-1.5 kg

38

preemie, approx. 1.5-2.5 kg

44

small newborn, approx. 2.5-3.2 kg

50

newborn, approx. 3.2-4.2 kg

56

approx. 1-2 months

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Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



Read the whole pattern before you start, and knit a gauge swatch. Mark your own size in the tables so you do not have to search as you go. **Test knit version 1.0**

BEFORE YOU START

The jumper is knitted top-down with a round yoke and long sleeves. The skirt is knitted separately, also from the top down, with a folded waistband that a soft elastic is threaded through at the end. The two pieces share the charts, the gauge and the colours, but are knitted entirely independently.

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- knitting a jumper with a round yoke
- dividing for body and sleeves, and working sleeves in the round
- knitting a skirt with a folded, elasticated waistband
- adjusting the length and finishing with a picot edge

DIFFICULTY

Easy to slightly experienced. The sleeves are the only part with few stitches on the needle, and there Magic Loop or double-pointed needles help.

SIZES AND FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

The pattern is graded in five sizes. Choose by the baby's chest measurement, not by age: premature babies grow at their own pace, and a couple of weeks makes a big difference. Between two sizes, take the larger one, since a garment that is slightly big lasts longer.

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THE BABY'S MEASUREMENTS

Size	Suits	Baby chest	Ease
32	preemie, approx. 1.0-1.5 kg	24 cm	4,6 cm
38	preemie, approx. 1.5-2.5 kg	27 cm	5,4 cm
44	small newborn, approx. 2.5-3.2 kg	30 cm	6,2 cm
50	newborn, approx. 3.2-4.2 kg	33 cm	7,0 cm
56	approx. 1-2 months	36 cm	7,8 cm

FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

Size	Jumper chest	Jumper length	Sleeve length	Skirt waist	Skirt length
32	30,5 cm	18 cm	13 cm	30,5 cm	17 cm
38	34,3 cm	21 cm	15 cm	34,3 cm	19 cm
44	38,1 cm	23 cm	17 cm	38,1 cm	21 cm
50	41,9 cm	25 cm	19 cm	41,9 cm	23 cm
56	45,7 cm	27 cm	21 cm	45,7 cm	25 cm

Every number in the pattern is given in its own column per size. Find your column once, mark it, and read only that one from there on.

YARN, TOOLS AND GAUGE

YARN AND NEEDLES

DROPS Merino Extra Fine, 50 g = approx. 105 m, in strawberry pink, leaf green and a small amount of cream white. 4 mm needles, double-pointed or Magic Loop for the small rounds. The amounts below include a good margin, and are given per size.

Tools	For what
4 mm needles	double-pointed or Magic Loop for neck, sleeves and waistband
Soft elastic	approx. 1 cm wide, for the skirt waistband
Darning needle	for weaving in ends and sewing down the waistband and picot
Stitch marker	to mark the beginning of the round and each sleeve side

YARN AMOUNT

Size	Pink	Green	Cream
32	540 g	55 g	5 g
38	685 g	65 g	5 g
44	850 g	70 g	5 g
50	1030 g	75 g	5 g
56	1235 g	85 g	5 g

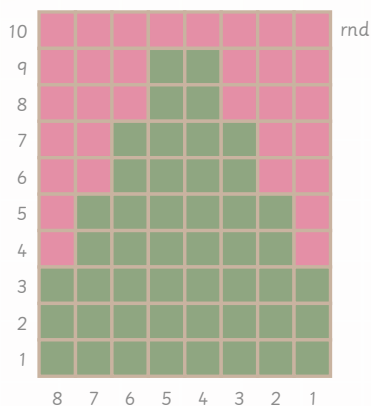
GAUGE

21 stitches and 28 rounds in stocking stitch = 10 x 10 cm on 4 mm needles. Knit your swatch in the round, not flat, and measure it after washing and drying flat. More than 21 stitches means going up a needle size, fewer means going down. The gauge decides every measurement in the pattern, and on garments this small a slight difference quickly becomes several centimetres.

LEAF AND SEED CHARTS

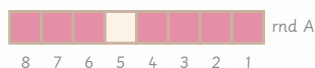
Both charts are read from the bottom up, and each round from right to left, the same way you knit. The leaf repeat is 8 stitches and is repeated all the way round the yoke. The number of repeats for your size is given further on.

LEAF, 8 STITCHES x 10 ROUNDS

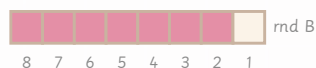


SEED, 8 STITCHES

A



B



The seeds are single cream white stitches scattered over the pink. Work round A, then 2-3 rounds in pink, then round B. Repeat as densely or as sparsely as you like.

The float behind the work is never longer than 3 stitches in either chart. That is deliberate: long loose strands on the inside are both uncomfortable against the skin and something small fingers can catch in. Keep the carried yarn loose enough that the work does not pucker.

JUMPER · 1 · NECK AND YOKE

Cast on in green on 4 mm needles, join in the round and work 5 rounds of twisted rib. Divide the stitches into 8 equal sections and place a marker between each. Increase 1 stitch in each section every other round, that is 8 stitches per increase round, until you have the stitch count in your column. Then work the leaf repeat from page 5 over 8 stitches, repeated as many times as the column says, and finish with 1 round in pink.

Size	Cast on	Sts per section	Increase rounds	Yoke	Leaf repeats
32	48 sts	6	5	88 sts	11 x
38	48 sts	6	7	104 sts	13 x
44	56 sts	7	8	120 sts	15 x
50	56 sts	7	10	136 sts	17 x
56	64 sts	8	11	152 sts	19 x

The jumper has no neck opening. In sizes 50 and 56 you may work the first four rows back and forth and make one buttonhole, as on the dress. The head then passes through more easily and the neck does not have to stretch.

JUMPER · 2 · DIVIDE FOR BODY AND SLEEVES

Read the row for your size from left to right, in the order you knit: the front, the stitches you place on hold for the first sleeve, the stitches you cast on under the arm, the back, then the same sleeve on the other side. The jumper casts on 4 stitches under each arm, two more than the dress and the romper, because a sleeve needs a little extra width at the underarm.

Size	Front	Hold for sleeve	Cast on	Back	Body
32	28	16	4	28	64 sts
38	32	20	4	32	72 sts
44	36	24	4	36	80 sts
50	40	28	4	40	88 sts
56	44	32	4	44	96 sts

JUMPER · 3 · THE BODY

Work in pink stocking stitch in the round with seeds: seed round A, 2-3 rounds in pink, then seed round B. Repeat as densely or sparsely as you like. Work until the body measures the length in your column, measured straight down from the underarm. Change to green, work 6 rounds of twisted rib and cast off with stretch.

Size	Body stitches	Chest	Length from underarm	Rounds of rib
32	64 sts	30,5 cm	9 cm	6
38	72 sts	34,3 cm	10 cm	6
44	80 sts	38,1 cm	11 cm	6
50	88 sts	41,9 cm	12 cm	6
56	96 sts	45,7 cm	13 cm	6

Always cast off loosely in rib. A tight cast-off stops the jumper from pulling down over the chest, and that shows most in the smallest sizes.

JUMPER · 4 · THE SLEEVES

Place the held sleeve stitches on the needle and pick up the stitches under the arm. Place a marker at the centre of the underarm. Work in pink stocking stitch in the round, with a few seeds spaced well apart. Decrease 1 stitch at each side of the marker, that is 2 stitches per decrease round, spread evenly over the length of the sleeve. The number of decrease rounds is given in your column.

Size	Held stitches	Pick up	Upper arm	Decrease rounds	Cuff	Sleeve length
32	16	4	20 sts	2	16 sts	13 cm
38	20	4	24 sts	3	18 sts	15 cm
44	24	4	28 sts	4	20 sts	17 cm
50	28	4	32 sts	5	22 sts	19 cm
56	32	4	36 sts	6	24 sts	21 cm

THE CUFF

When the sleeve measures approx. 2 cm less than the sleeve length in the table, change to green and work 6 rounds of twisted rib. Cast off with stretch. Work the second sleeve exactly the same.

SKIRT · 5 · THE WAISTBAND

Cast on loosely in green and join in the round. The stitch count already divides by 8, so the leaf repeat comes out even without adjustment. Work 2.5 cm in stocking stitch, 1 purl round for the fold line, then another 2.5 cm in stocking stitch. Place the cast-on edge on a spare needle and knit one stitch from each needle together all the way round, leaving an opening of approx. 2 cm for the elastic.

Size	Cast on	Leaf repeats	Waist	Waistband height
32	64 sts	8 x	30,5 cm	2 x 2,5 cm
38	72 sts	9 x	34,3 cm	2 x 2,5 cm
44	80 sts	10 x	38,1 cm	2 x 2,5 cm
50	88 sts	11 x	41,9 cm	2 x 2,5 cm
56	96 sts	12 x	45,7 cm	2 x 2,5 cm

Cast on loosely. The waistband must stretch over the hips, and a tight cast-on edge is the most common reason a baby skirt will not go on.

SKIRT · 6 · LEAVES, WIDTH AND LENGTH

Work the leaf repeat from page 5 over 8 stitches, repeated as many times as your column says. Then change to pink and work *k2, M1*, repeat round. The skirt is now at full width. Continue in pink stocking stitch with scattered seeds until the skirt measures the length in the last column, measured below the waistband.

Size	Waistband stitches	Leaf repeats	*k2, M1* gives	Skirt width	Length from waistband
32	64 sts	8 x	96 sts	45,7 cm	14 cm
38	72 sts	9 x	108 sts	51,4 cm	16 cm
44	80 sts	10 x	120 sts	57,1 cm	18 cm
50	88 sts	11 x	132 sts	62,9 cm	20 cm
56	96 sts	12 x	144 sts	68,6 cm	22 cm

The leaves on the skirt point downwards, just as on the jumper yoke, so the two pieces match when worn together.

SKIRT · 7 · PICOT EDGE AND ELASTIC

THE PICOT EDGE

Work 3 rounds in pink, then an eyelet round: *yarn over, k2tog*, repeat round. Work 3 more rounds and cast off loosely. Fold the edge to the inside along the eyelet round and sew it down loosely on the wrong side.

THE ELASTIC

Measure the baby's waist and cut a soft elastic 1 cm shorter than the measurement. Thread it through the waistband with a safety pin, sew the ends firmly together with several rows of stitches, then close the opening in the waistband. The elastic should hold the skirt up without marking the skin. Check with a finger: you should slip easily under the waistband.

A premature baby's skin is especially delicate. If in doubt, choose the looser elastic and tighten it later if needed.

FOR YOU, THE TEST KNITTER

This edition of the set is a test knit version. Every stitch count has been calculated from the babies' measurements and the gauge, and checked against the others, but nobody has knitted from the pattern yet. You are the first. That means you may run into things I have not seen, and that is exactly why I need you.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

- Which size you knitted, and which yarn and needles you used.
- Your own gauge, measured on a washed swatch dried flat.
- The finished measurements of the garment after washing, in the form below.
- Anything unclear: a sentence you had to read three times, a stitch count that did not add up, a place where you had to guess.
- A photo of the finished garment, on the baby if you like.
- Tell me if the pattern reminds you of one you have seen before. Strawberry Dream is drawn for LME, and I want to know straight away if something still sits too close to something else.

MEASUREMENT FORM, FILL IN AFTER WASHING

Size knitted

My gauge, stitches per 10 cm

My gauge, rounds per 10 cm

Yarn and needles

Chest after washing

Total length after washing

Time taken, roughly

Yarn used, grams

HOW TO SEND IT IN

Send the form, your comments and any photos to <https://lmexplorers.com/teststrikk>. The deadline is given in the email the pattern came in.

Nothing is too small to mention. Whatever tripped you up will trip up the next knitter too, and it is far easier to fix now than later.

FINISHING AND AFTERCARE

CHECKLIST

- Weave in all ends flat and firmly on the wrong side. Do not cut them flush.
- Soak the work in lukewarm water with wool detergent. Do not rub or wring.
- Press the water out in a towel and dry the garment flat to the given measurements.
- Check all buttons, ties, edges and loose ends before the garment is worn.
- Check that the elastic sits softly and leaves no marks after an hour of wear.
- Measure the garment after washing and write the numbers in the form on the previous page.

SAFETY

Buttons and ties on baby garments must always be checked before use, and the garment worn only under supervision. Sew buttons on with strong thread and go over them again after every wash. On a premature baby the garment sits right against the skin, so feel that no seam or knot presses hard.

Happy knitting!

STRAWBERRY DREAM

THE WHOLE COLLECTION

- Strawberry Dream dress, sleeveless with a leaf yoke and a flared skirt.
- Strawberry Dream romper with skirt, with a nappy panel and buttons at the crotch.
- Strawberry Dream jumper and skirt, a two-piece set with an elasticated waist.
- Strawberry Dream mittens, thumbless, with a connecting cord.
- Strawberry Dream booties, with a folded rib cuff and ties at the ankle.

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